

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with more than five years of experience in cyber security operations, incident response, threat intelligence, vulnerability management, and stakeholder engagement within large, complex professional organisations. I am experienced in managing day-to-day cyber security operations to minimise security incident risk, providing clear security requirements into major IT change programmes, and engaging confidently with senior stakeholders across all levels of an organisation, including academic leadership, professional services directors, and technology governance boards. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I have served as the senior escalation lead for security incidents including data breach investigations, and I have provided security guidance across a diverse portfolio of infrastructure and application change projects. I bring a professional and considered approach to cyber security that translates naturally into professional services environments, where clear communication, discretion, and the ability to work alongside senior stakeholders are as important as technical depth. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cyber Security Operations:** Day-to-day operations management to minimise incident risk; alert monitoring, triage, investigation, and escalation; SIEM and EDR/XDR platform management
- **SIEM:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, playbooks, workbooks), Splunk
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender
- **Incident Response:** Senior escalation lead, full-lifecycle IR (NIST 800-61), MITRE ATT&CK, data breach investigation and notification, playbook authoring
- **Threat Intelligence and Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting via Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; threat intelligence integration and indicator of compromise (IOC) management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), penetration test oversight and remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Email, Endpoint, and Device Security:** Mimecast, CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM, Tanium, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Senior leadership communication; security requirement provision to change programmes; third-party and supplier risk management
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC, UK GDPR / Data Protection Act 2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Manage day-to-day cyber security operations across an 8,000-user global estate, maintaining continuous monitoring and response capability to minimise security incident risk and protect sensitive data assets
- Serve as the senior incident response escalation lead, coordinating full-lifecycle investigation, containment, remediation, and reporting of security incidents and data breaches, including engagement with senior leadership and regulatory notification processes where required
- Provide security requirements and expert guidance to the organisation's technology change programme, ensuring security-by-design principles are embedded in infrastructure, application, and process change

- Engage confidently with senior stakeholders across academic, professional services, and IT leadership to communicate risk posture, incident status, and control recommendations in clear, non-technical language
- Conduct threat intelligence analysis and proactive threat hunting to identify and neutralise threats before they escalate, using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL
- Manage vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, overseeing penetration testing activities and tracking remediation against agreed timescales
- Operate and optimise SIEM, EDR/XDR, and broader security tooling including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- Maintain and continuously improve incident response playbooks, standard operating procedures, and security operational documentation to ensure team consistency and regulatory readiness

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security alerts from SIEM and EDR platforms, escalating incidents in accordance with defined playbooks and reporting confirmed incidents to senior stakeholders
- Supported incident response and data breach investigation activities, assisting in containment, eradication, and evidence preservation in line with NIST 800-61 and UK GDPR requirements
- Provided security guidance to infrastructure and application change projects, reviewing designs for security risks and communicating findings to technical and non-technical audiences
- Managed identity and access management operations including Microsoft Entra ID administration, Conditional Access policy management, and MFA rollout to strengthen identity security across the organisation
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and produced remediation reports using Nessus and Tenable.io, tracking issue resolution and reporting progress to management
- Authored incident response playbooks and security awareness materials to improve team response consistency and organisational security culture
- Managed third-party and supplier security assessments, reviewing security questionnaires and assessing vendor risk profiles against organisational standards

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed endpoint security, patch management, and security monitoring in a cloud-first SaaS and FinTech environment handling sensitive supplier and financial data
- Administered identity and access controls including Active Directory provisioning, access reviews, and privilege management to enforce least-privilege principles
- Supported security incident monitoring and initial triage, escalating confirmed events and assisting in investigation activities
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities including evidence collection, control gap analysis, and security policy documentation
- Managed MDM solutions for corporate device management, maintaining security baselines across a distributed workforce

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised UAL's hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC), integrating CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel to deliver enterprise-wide threat detection and response capability
- Led complex security incident investigations including data breach scenarios, managing stakeholder communication, regulatory notification processes, and post-incident remediation
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, delivering comprehensive endpoint and identity threat protection
- Designed and implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) at UAL, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and establishing a complete audit trail for all administrative activity
- Led UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, co-ordinating cross-team remediation across technical and operational controls and achieving certification within the target timescale

- Developed a comprehensive library of incident response playbooks and operational procedures, materially improving team response consistency and reducing time to contain and resolve security incidents

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)